3. Nature of the diet

4. Individual variations in requirements

The requirement for vitamin C or ascorbic acid is actually 20 mg/day, but since the vitamin is easily destroyed during pre-preparation, cooking and storage, the recommended intake is twice the requirement and is 40 mg/day

## 1.1.1 Factors influencing RDA

The RDAs apply to healthy individuals and are set high enough to cover individual variation. Recommended dietary allowances of an individual depend on many factors like

1. **Age** - Adults require more total calories than a child, whereas a growing child requires more calories per kg of body weight than an adult.
2. **Sex** - Males with high Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR) require more calories than females.
3. **Physical activity**– The type of activity also determines the energy requirements. Based on the nature of work and level of activity different occupations are classified into three categories:
   - Sedentary
   - Moderate
   - Heavy

**Sedentary (light work):** A sedentary person is one who does most of the -work sitting at one place using only his hands and head. A few examples of individuals undertaking sedentary work include teachers, tailors, typists, clerks, office executives, housewives who have household help.

**Moderate (neither too light nor too strenuous hard work):** A person is said to be a moderately active individual if his/her work involves the use of both hands and feet continuously but not very strenuously. A few examples of people who would belong to this group would include postmen, housemaids, servants, fishermen, agricultural labourers, housewives who do most of the housework themselves manually.

**Heavy (hard, strenuous work):** A person is a heavy worker if he/she is involved in hard/ strenuous work using hands and feet very fast and continuously for a long period each day. Rickshaw pullers, stone cutters, mine workers, coolies belong to this group.

**4. Physiological state** : Nutrient requirements are increased in conditions of physiological stress such as pregnancy and lactation.

**5. Disease and drugs** : Drugs prescribed for treatment can alter the requirement of one or more nutrients.

## 1.1.2 Recommended dietary intakes for adults



**Age : 18 - 29 years**

**Weight : 60 kg**



**Age : 18 - 29 years**

**Weight : 55 kg**

**Fig.1.1 Reference man and Woman**

Recommended dietary intakes for adults are based on age, sex, body size and activity level. In the case of adults, there are substantial variations in RDA particularly for energy and protein depending on the age, body weight,and activity pattern. That is why RDAs have worked out on the basis of a **"Reference individual".** The **Reference man** is an **Indian man** in the age



Unit 1 RECOMMENDED DIETARY ALLOWANCE AND MEAL PLANNING.indd 3 1/19/2020 2:51:00 PM